Project report

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1. Introduction

As a Student Digital Ambassador on this project, my job has been to help my classmates use the digital world safely and professionally. Digital literacy skills are important because the digital world is a big part of our work and school lives. I have done five different tasks for this project, each one corresponding to one of the five modules in the CSE0001 course. This includes making an educational infographic, a professional online portfolio, writing formal emails, coding and working together in the cloud, and learning how to stop cybercrime. I have put all of these resources into one GitHub repository to make a complete Digital Literacy Portfolio that I will use to present to the faculty committee and share with my batch.

Task 1 Write-up

I made an infographic about digital literacy for the first task. This will help me teach my classmates how important it is to know how to use technology. I used Canva to make the infographic because it is simple to use and has a lot of templates. The infographic has a short explanation of what digital literacy is, a list of the most important digital tools a student should know (like GitHub and Google Workspace), and a list of the most important safe internet practices a student should know (like Two-Factor Authentication and financial safety). It was hard for me to write short descriptions of important ideas, which is what I learned from this task. This is because it's hard to keep the description short while still getting the point across. The infographic that was sent out is a quick reference guide that any first-year student will be able to understand and use.

Task 2 Write-up

To be accepted into the academic and professional community, you need a digital professional presence. It's no longer a luxury. To do the task, I made my online presence on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. For my GitHub profile, I changed it to include a detailed README file that lists things like my B.Tech branch, my current Python projects (like my virtual assistant project called Jarvis), and my goal to learn about artificial intelligence. I updated my LinkedIn profile to include information about my education at VIT Bhopal and the degree I'm currently working on. I plan to keep using the platforms for the next four years by adding my coding assignments to GitHub and my certifications to LinkedIn to make a strong digital resume.

Task 3 Write-up

For this task, I chose to use coding practice and cloud-based collaboration tools. HackerRank was the coding practice platform of choice, and the "Python If-Else" challenge for beginners was completed successfully. From an academic point of view, this platform is very helpful because it connects the theoretical knowledge of programming languages with how they are used in real life. For the collaboration part, Google Forms were used to make a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" in Google Workspace. With a link to a Google Sheet, the form was made sure to have both multiple-choice and short-answer questions. From a university's point of view, these kinds of cloud-based platforms are very important because they make it easy to collect data during group tasks.

Task 4 Write-up

One way that problems can happen when digital communication breaks down is when a student sends an email to a professor with a question but doesn't include their full name, course code, or subject line. An email with "I need help" and a nickname in the address, for example, might not be noticed. The professor will have to waste time sending emails asking for identification, even if they notice it. This is making me angry. To learn about etiquette, it's important to use a very specific subject line and write the email with a greeting, a specific question, and a closing. This makes sure that we can communicate clearly and quickly in both school and business settings.

Task 5 Write-up

While researching UPI and payment fraud, the thing that has shocked me the most is how much scammers use psychological tricks, like the false urgency technique, instead of real hacking skills. I thought that most cybercrimes would involve complicated coding and other things like that, but the truth is that scammers just use screen-sharing apps to scare people into giving them their UPI PINs. It was very scary to think about how a phone call threatening to cut off a mobile network could lead to an empty bank account. While doing research, I have learned how to change the way I use technology. I now know that I need to use the "pause and verify" method. This means that I will never act on an urgent phone call that asks for immediate action, and I will always check the request through official channels.

Conclusion

In the end, this project was a very useful way to learn. I went from passively receiving digital content to actively managing my professional digital footprint. Setting up the GitHub repository was a hands-on way to learn the basics of version control and documentation. Additionally, my study of cyber threats and email etiquette equipped me with the interpersonal skills essential for proficient communication. As a Digital Ambassador, I now have the hard and soft skills I need to help myself and my classmates with our schoolwork.

Referance:

- Canva (infographics): canva.com
- GitHub: github.com
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com
- HackerRank: hackerrank.com
- Google Forms: forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in